Technical Manual for Operating Technical Committees of the IEEE Systems, Man, and Cybernetics Society

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Definition of Abbreviations in this Technical Committee Manual

SMCS	IEEE Systems, Man, and Cybernetics Society
SMCS	Conferences and meetings sponsored by SMCS
BoG	SMC Board of Governors
VP	Vice President
AVP	Associate Vice President
Pubs	Publications
TC	Technical Committee
TC Chair(s)	Chair(s) leading a Technical Committee
CYB	Cybernetics area of the SMC Society
HMS	Human Machine Systems area of the SMC Society
SSE	Systems Science and Engineering area of the SMC Society
CYBC	Cybernetics Committee (chaired by VP CYB and assisted by the AVP CYB) and its members as defined in Article III of the SMCS ByLaws
HMSC	Human Machine Systems Committee (chaired by VP HMS and assisted by the AVP HMS) and its members as defined in Article III of the SMCS ByLaws
SSEC	Systems Science and Engineering Committee (chaired by VP SSE and assisted by the AVP SSE) and its members as defined in Article III of the SMCS ByLaws

The Role of VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE

(1) The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall have responsibility for increasing the technical qualities of SMCS activities in their corresponding areas (see Article III of the ByLaws). These activities include SMCS meetings, publications, TC activities, and Chapters' activities.
(2) The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall chair the corresponding committees (i.e., CYBC, HMSC, SSEC) and serve as committee members of the Publication Committee and the Conference and Meeting Committee (see Article III of the ByLaws).

(3) The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall encourage TC activities and manage TCs with the help of the AVP in the corresponding areas (i.e., AVP CYB, AVP HMS, AVP SSE). The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall collect semi-annual activity reports from the TCs and submit them to the BoG. Managing the TCs shall include the decision or recommendation for changing TC Chair(s), merging TCs, and creating/disolving TCs.
(4) The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall approve the change of TC Chair(s) and report the change to the BoG. The VP CYB, VP HMS, and VP SSE shall ask the VP Pubs, Web Master, and Newsletter Editor to announce the change to SMCS members.
(5) When the VP CYB, VP HMS, or VP SSE receives a request for creating a new TC or discontinuing a TC, he or she shall discuss the request with the corresponding area committee members (i.e., CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC) and, may consult with the TC Chairs. When the corresponding area committee approves the request, the corresponding area VP shall report the decision to the BoG and ask the VP Pubs, Web Master, and Newsletter Editor to announce the change to SMC Society members.

The Role of Area Committees CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC

(1) (for conferences) Area committees CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC, in consultation with the corresponding area TC Chair(s) whenever appropriate, shall recommend to the Organizing Committees of SMCS meetings and conferences policies and plans to increase their technical quality (see Article III of the ByLaws). These recommendations may include the length between paper submission due date and the conference date, length of review days, review policy, the page length of submission papers, policy for no-shows, and other related issues.
(2) (for publications) Area committees CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC, in consultation with the corresponding area TC Chair(s) whenever appropriate, shall recommend to the Publication Committee policies and plans to enhance the quality of publications (see Article III of the ByLaws). They may include the review policy, types of publications, types of papers, and characterization of publications, papers and other digital outputs such as technical videos and webinar.
(3) (for TC activity) area TC Chair(s), in consultation with the corresponding area TC Chair(s) whenever appropriate, shall analyze the coverage of TCs within SMCS scope, discuss the necessity of creating new TCs and merging existing TCs, and support the TC activities (see Article III of the ByLaws).
(4) Area committees CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC, in consultation with the corresponding area TC Chair(s) whenever appropriate, shall collect technical information and create a database for future use. They may include special sessions, invited talks, webinars, special issues, and other records that are useful for enhancing the technical quality of SMCS activities.
(5) Area committees CYBC, HMSC, and SSEC, in consultation with the corresponding area TC Chair(s) whenever appropriate, shall discuss the request of creating a new TC or discontinuing an existing TC.

The Role of Area AVP

(1) The area AVP shall support the corresponding area VP.
(2) The area AVP shall support the TCs and collect requests and opinions from the TCs and report to the corresponding area VP.
(3) The area AVP shall analyze the technical trend within SMCS scopes and make a plan for creating new TCs, combing or discontinuing existing TCs through the discussion with the corresponding area VP.
(4) The area AVP shall assist the corresponding area VP in promoting the TC activities.
(5) The area AVP shall support the corresponding area VP in making and enforcing policies and procedures.

TC Activity

The TCs collectively define the scope of the SMCS technical activities. They serve as building blocks of the SMCS and should attract SMC members to enroll on their TCs.

(1) Each TC must propose at least one special session at the annual SMC conference.
(2) TCs shall actively contribute to the SMCS technical activities, for instance, by serving as members conference technical committee, Special Interest Groups (SIGs), organizing workshops, conferences, special issues and tutorial papers for the SMCS periodicals, by contributing articles to the SMC Newsletters, or by organizing activities to encourage collaboration between members and relevant industries.

TC Chair(s)

(1) All TC Chair(s) and Co-Chairs must be SMCS members.
(2) All TC Chair(s) shall contribute to conferences/workshops sponsored by SMCS by organizing the conferences/workshops, organizing Special sessions, or serving as program committee members.
(3) TC Chair(s) shall actively recruit new SMC members through TC activities.
(4) TC Chair(s) shall report their TC activities bi-annually to the corresponding area VP (i.e., CYB, HMS, and SSE).
(5) If a TC Chair failed to perform any of the mentioned TC Activities (1) and (2), the corresponding area VP may decide or recommend the changing the TC Chair, combining his/her TC with other TCs, and discontinuing his/her TC after taking the TC's situation in consideration.

Evaluation of Yearly TCs Performance

The evaluation of the yearly TC performance by the corresponding area VP (supported by the corresponding area AVP and area committee if necessary) shall be based on the following criteria:

(1) Provision of bi-annual TC reports (incl. TC composition statistics)
(2) Overview of TC activities (incl. joint TC member publications, support to SMCS and other IEEE/non-IEEE related conferences, organization of special issues, other event support)
(3) Overview of TC member acquisition
(4) Up-to-date TC web page
(5) Outline of future TC plans

Policy and Procedure to Create/Terminate/Restructure a TC

(1) Procedure for creating a new TC:
   (a) Submit to the corresponding area VP a request of creating a new TC with a TC name, names of TC Chair and members, objectives, and activity plan. The TC Chair(s) must be SMC members.
   (b) The corresponding area committee shall discuss the request by checking the activity plan and possible overlapping technical areas with existing TCs. The corresponding area TC Chair(s) shall be consulted.
   (c) Once the corresponding area VP approves the new TC based on the discussion of the corresponding area committee, TC members may start their activity.
   (d) The corresponding area VP shall report the decision to the BoG, inform all TCs, and shall ask the VP Pubs, Web Master, and Newsletter Editor to announce the decision.

(2) Procedure for discontinuing / dissolving a TC:
   (a) The discontinuation of an existing TC could be made if the TC has been inactive for at least one year and there is no credible plan by the TC to revive it. The judgment of a TC being inactive should be largely based on the TC's bi-annual reports and the final decision rests with the corresponding area committee. Alternatively, the discontinuation of an existing TC could also be made by its chair and support of at least two of their TC memebrs by submitting a request to the corresponding area with reason.
   (b) When necessary, the corresponding area VP may consult the corresponding area TC Chair(s) before a final decision is made.
   (c) The corresponding area VP shall report the decision to the BoG, inform all TCs, and shall ask the VP Pubs, Web Master, and Newsletter Editor to announce the decision.

(3) Procedure for Making Major Changes to an Existing TC:
   (a) Major changes to an existing TC may include a change of TC Chair(s) or a significant change of a TC's technical content. The TC Chair(s) shall propose the intended changes to the corresponding area VP.
   (b) Once the corresponding area VP approves the change, he or she shall report the change to the BoG, inform all TCs, and also ask the VP Pubs, Web Master, and Newsletter Editor to announce the changes.